

it is worth knowing about. When somebody speaks up for justice, they are always under danger of attack by anti-social elements. In remembrance of the murder of human rights activist Natalia Estemirova in Chechnya in 2009, a Swedish organisation called Civil Rights Defenders has launched the Natalia Project. The system basically involves an IoT wristband for use by activists. When the alarm is triggered or the wristband is forcibly removed, it sends out an alert along with location information to a network, which immediately sends other members, who are located nearby, to the aid of the attacked activist.

## MyTraps

(<http://mytraps.com/>)

A socially-impactful solution developed by Purdue based Spensa Technologies, MyTraps helps farmers to remotely monitor and manage pest attacks on their farms. The solution uses wireless insect traps, an online cloud service and a dashboard. Several Wi-Fi-capable insect traps called Z-Traps are installed across the farm to lure and capture pest samples. These samples are analysed and the information is wirelessly conveyed using a base station to MyTraps service and the user's smart device. The user gets to see a satellite image of the field with details on the infestation, counts of pests captured in each trap, analysis of pesticide use and suggestions. This helps farmers to take further action to save their crops.

## CubeSensors

(<http://cubesensors.com>)

These small, sleek, wireless, sensor-packed cubes provide a lot of actionable information to improve the quality of your life. Unlike fitness monitors that keep watching you—what you eat, how much you sleep and

whether you exercise—CubeSensors watch the environment and provide information about air quality, lighting, temperature, humidity, noise, pressure, etc, along with suggestions to improve the conditions.

## Revolv

(<http://revolv.com/>)

Not just Revolv, other smart-home hubs including Iris and Staples Connect are also becoming popular these days, because managing umpteen apps to control the devices in your home can be painful. Smart-home hubs like Revolv help you bring together most standard, branded home-automation products under the control of a single hub, and hence a single app. So, you can switch-off all your lights, turn-on your oven, program the washing machine, and do many more such things using a single, easy-to-use interface.

## Quirky's egg minder

(<http://www.quirky.com>)

Egg minder is a smart egg tray that manages your stock of eggs. By telling you when eggs are about to go bad, it helps avoid wastage; and by alerting you when your stock is running out, it makes sure you have eggs for tomorrow's breakfast. What makes this gadget worth a look is its simplicity.

Egg minder is part of the Wink range of products developed jointly by product-development platform Quirky, GE and Electric Imp. Other products in the range include an intelligent personal dashboard, smart piggy bank, power strip and multipurpose sensor.

Internet of Things is no longer a distant dream but an exciting reality, as is evident from the many IoT products populating store shelves.

sensors, which can be placed at problematic areas to capture videos and

wirelessly transmit relevant data like number of vehicles in real-time to the main server. The data is then sorted into data packages, which can offer insights into current and future patterns and trends. This can be used to come up with practical solutions to traffic congestion.

robotics but is also focused on developing smart robots like Minion Bot and developing home-automation products to keep in line with the IoT boom. Their award-winning wireless programmer and wireless sensor node can be used by learners to experiment with their own connected products.

The worldwide enthusiasm about Internet of Things and Big Data is surely getting reflected in India, too. It would be nice to see this ecosystem grow, because Indian start-ups will be able to provide products with a *desi* touch and more customised, localised services at affordable rates to us. ●



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## Inventrom

(<http://www.inventrom.com>)

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